**Apollo Tyres x ACC Case Competition: Round 3**

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## Introduction

Apollo Tyres is a Gurugram-based tyre maker with operations across India and Europe and became the lead sponsor of the Indian men's and women's cricket teams in September 2025. Its logo now sits on the front of the Team India jersey until March 2028. In cities, that sponsorship has done what it was meant to do: people see the jersey, and they know the name.

Rural India is a different story. Apollo makes tyres for tractors, trailers and other farm vehicles, and rural India is where most of the future growth in this business sits. But farmers and landowners do not yet think of Apollo first when their tractor needs new tyres. The company has decided that cricket, the sport it has already paid for, should be the way in. What it needs now is a plan for how to actually do it on the ground.

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## Background

1. **About Apollo Tyres**
    - Founded in 1972 and headquartered in Gurugram, with plants in India and Europe.
    - FY26 (April 2025 to March 2026) consolidated revenue of Rs 28,471 crore, up 9% on the year. India is the largest part of the business.
    - Strong in truck, bus and car tyres. Also makes farm tyres, including Farm King (India's first farm radial), Virat 23 (India's first 23-lug tractor tyre for hard soil) and the Krishak range.
    - Farm tyres were roughly 8 to 10% of Apollo's Indian revenue as of 2019, a small slice of a much bigger company.
2. **Apollo's Cricket Assets**
    - Lead sponsor of Team India (men's and women's) from September 2025 to March 2028, for about Rs 579 crore.
    - The deal covers 121 bilateral matches and 21 ICC matches, across all three formats, with the Apollo logo on the front of the jersey.
    - It also allows Apollo to work with the BCCI on activations and fan engagement.
    - Recall among urban cricket fans is high. Whether the jersey has done anything for farmers is untested.

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## The Challenge

Apollo has the biggest jersey in Indian sport on its side, but a farmer in Bareilly or Bathinda still does not ask for an Apollo tyre by name. Apollo needs a cricket-led plan that achieves the following:

1. **Build Recall:** Make Apollo the first tyre brand a farmer or landowner names when asked, not just a logo he has seen on TV.
2. **Turn Recall into Sales:** Make sure the cricket activity leads to more farmers walking into a dealer and buying Apollo tyres.
3. **Make the Sponsorship Work Harder:** Get rural value out of the Team India deal before it ends in March 2028, and decide what else in cricket is worth backing.
4. **Prove It Worked:** Spend within a sensible budget and measure the impact on recall and sales clearly enough that Apollo can decide whether to scale it.

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**The Problem Statement**

*How can Apollo Tyres use cricket, including its Team India sponsorship, to become the first tyre brand that farmers and landowners think of, and turn that recall into tractor and farm tyre sales in rural India, in a way that is affordable and measurable?*

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**Guidelines for Students' Solutions (necessary but not exhaustive)**

Students should develop a detailed proposal addressing the following:

1. **Diagnosis and Target**
    - Explain why Apollo's recall is weak among farmers and landowners.
    - Define the target customer and the focus geographies.
2. **Formats and Properties**
    - Recommend which cricket formats, properties or events Apollo should back, and why.
    - Show how the Team India sponsorship fits into the plan.
3. **On-Ground Activation Plan**
    - Lay out what happens in villages and towns, who runs it, and when.
    - Name the partners involved (dealers, tractor makers, local leagues, farmer groups or others).
    - Include any digital or media support that reaches rural audiences.
4. **From Recall to Sales**
    - Show how the activity moves a farmer from knowing the name to buying the tyre.
5. **Measurement Framework**
    - Define the KPIs for recall and sales, the baseline, and how impact will be attributed to the programme.
6. **Financial Plan**
    - Propose a budget.
    - Provide a cost-benefit analysis with the expected uplift.
7. **Roll-out Roadmap**
    - Show how the plan moves from a pilot to scale before March 2028.

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**Deliverable**

1. Prepare a **presentation of maximum 12 slides** summarising your solution, excluding the title slide and appendix. Minimum font size is 12pt. Do not include team names or member details.

   **Key components:**

   - A complete proposal covering formats and properties, the activation plan, the measurement framework and the budget.
   - Visual aids such as a rural customer journey, an activation calendar, a map of focus districts, or a recall-to-sales funnel.

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All the best!